



Department of Computer Engineering

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Experiment No.2

Aim: Customer Journey Mapping: Visualize the steps users take to interact with a product or service. Map out the customer journey from discovering a product to making a purchase and using the product. Identify pain points and opportunities for improvement.

Theory:

In any project, multiple stakeholders are involved either directly or indirectly, each having different expectations, levels of influence, and interests. Stakeholder mapping is an important project management and design-thinking activity that helps in identifying these stakeholders and understanding their roles within the system.

By categorizing stakeholders based on their influence and interest, project teams can prioritize communication, allocate resources efficiently, and manage relationships more effectively. This experiment enables students to analyze stakeholder roles systematically and develop strategies for engaging key stakeholders throughout the project lifecycle.

The main objectives of this activity are:

- To identify all internal and external stakeholders involved in an e-commerce system • To analyse the influence and interest of each stakeholder
- To classify stakeholders using a stakeholder matrix
- To understand how effective stakeholder management improves system performance and user satisfaction

Stakeholder Mapping for an E-Commerce Website

1. Identification of Stakeholders



An e-commerce website involves multiple stakeholders who directly or indirectly influence the success of the system. These stakeholders are identified based on their role in product delivery, service management, and customer interaction.

Key Stakeholders

- Customers
- Sellers / Vendors
- Platform Administrator
- Delivery / Logistics Partners
- Payment Gateway Providers
- Customer Support Team
- Marketing & Promotion Team
- Technical / IT Team
- Third-party Service Providers

2. Stakeholder Categorization (Influence vs Interest Matrix)

Level of Influence and Level of Interest

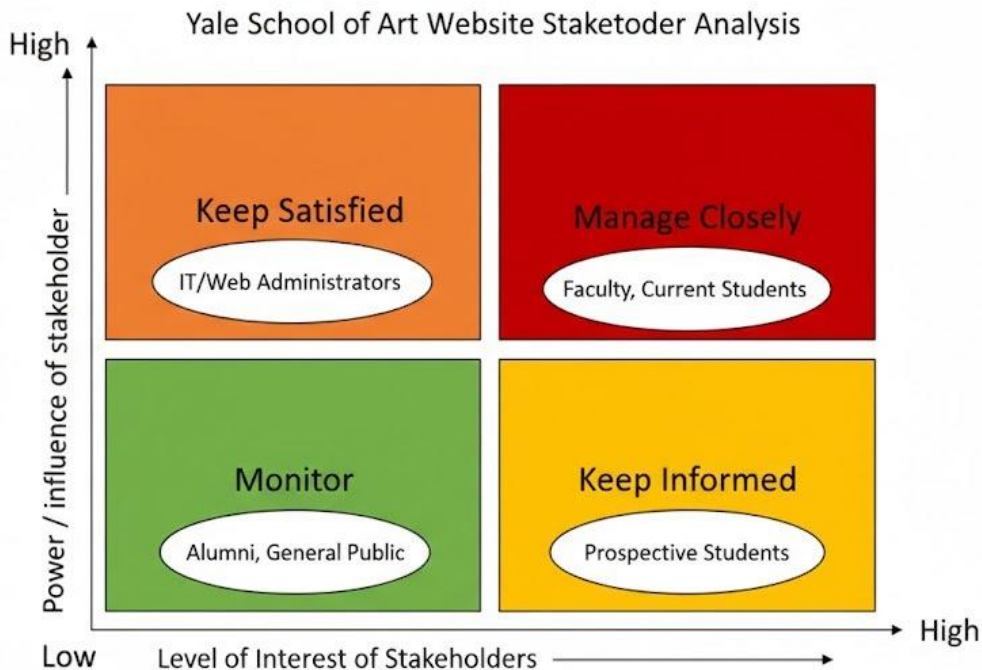
The level of influence refers to the amount of control or power a stakeholder has over a project. Stakeholders with high influence can affect decisions, resources, and outcomes, such as administrators or platform owners.

The level of interest indicates how much a stakeholder is concerned or involved in the project's success. Stakeholders with high interest are directly affected by the system, such as customers or sellers.

Understanding both levels helps in identifying which stakeholders need close management, regular communication, or minimal involvement. This classification supports effective planning, coordination, and successful project execution.



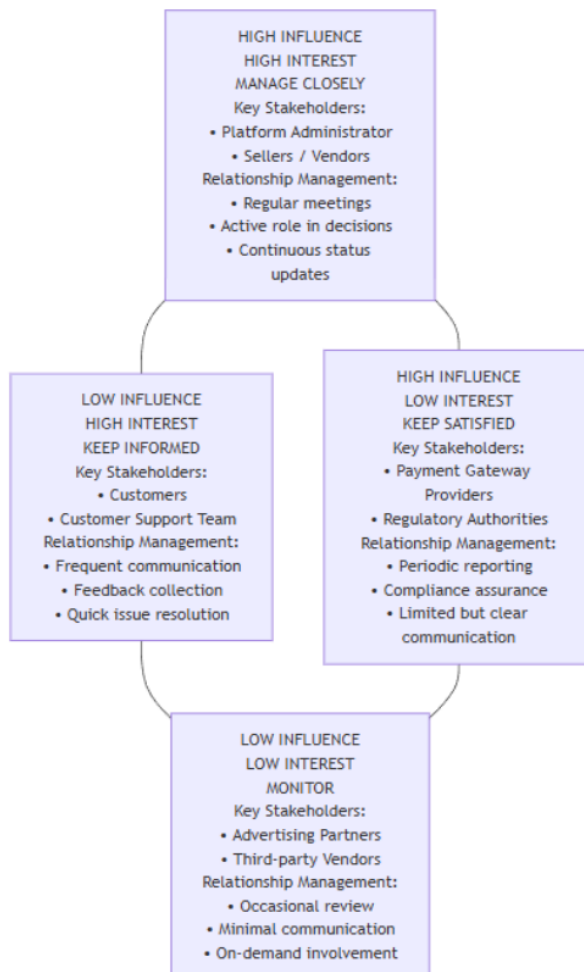
Stakeholder	Level of Influence	Level of Interest	Description
Platform Administrator	High	High	Controls policies, platform operations, and decision-making
Sellers / Vendors	High	High	Depend on platform for sales and revenue
Customers	Low	High	Use the system to purchase products
Delivery Partners	Low	Low	Responsible for order fulfilment
Payment Gateway Providers	High	Low	Handle secure online transactions
Customer Support Team	Low	High	Assist users and resolve issues
Marketing Team	Low	High	Promote products and platform
Technical Team	High	Low	Maintain system performance and security



Need for Stakeholder Relationship Management Strategy



A stakeholder relationship management strategy is needed to ensure that all stakeholders are engaged according to their level of influence and interest. It helps in maintaining effective communication, reducing conflicts, and aligning stakeholder expectations with project goals. Proper management of stakeholder relationships contributes to smooth project execution and overall project success.





Exercise 1: To identify stakeholders involved in a college library management system and classify them based on influence and interest.

1. Identification of Stakeholders

- **Library Staff (Internal):** Includes the Head Librarian and assistants who handle cataloging, fines, and procurement.
- **Faculty/Professors (Internal):** Educators who require specific resources for their curriculum and need to monitor student access to research materials.
- **Students (Internal):** The primary user base whose academic success depends on resource availability.
- **College Board/Principal (Internal):** The decision-makers focused on institutional prestige, budget compliance, and accreditation standards.
- **IT Department (Internal):** The technical gatekeepers responsible for API integrations (like Student IDs) and cybersecurity.
- **Software Vendor/Developers (External):** If the system is third-party, these are the people providing updates and patches.

2. Influence-Interest Matrix

Stakeholder	Level of Influence	Level of Interest	Description
Librarian	High	High	They are the "Product Owners." If the system is hard to use, the library stops functioning..
Principal	High	Low	They care about the "Big Picture" (costs and results) rather than whether the search bar is blue or green.
Students	Low	High	They are the largest user group. They have little power over the build but



			are most affected by its quality.
System Admin/IT dept	High	Low	They control the infrastructure. Technical friction here can kill the project entirely.
Book Vendors	Low	Low	Minimal impact on the software's core functionality; they only need basic data exports for orders.

3. Management Strategies

- **Manage Closely (Librarians & IT):** Conduct **User Acceptance Testing (UAT)** and weekly technical sync-ups to ensure the system handles daily workflows and security requirements perfectly.
- **Keep Satisfied (Principal/Board):** Provide **Executive Summaries** focusing on ROI, budget compliance, and high-level usage statistics rather than technical details.
- **Keep Informed (Students & Faculty):** Deploy **Digital Newsletters** or in-app notifications regarding new features, maintenance, and a simple feedback channel for "Feature Requests."
- **Monitor (Vendors):** Set up **Automated Notifications** for low-stock alerts or purchase orders to maintain the collection with minimal manual oversight.



Exercise 2: To perform detailed stakeholder analysis for a complex e-commerce platform involving multiple vendors and service providers.

1. Stakeholder Categorization

- **Internal:** Product Management, DevOps/Engineering, Legal/Compliance, and Regional Sales Teams.
- **External:** Tier-1 Merchants (Anchor Brands), Third-Party Sellers (SMEs), End-Consumers, Payment Processors (Stripe/PayPal), Logistics/Last-Mile Delivery Partners, and Data Privacy Regulators (GDPR/CCPA).

2. Influence-Interest Matrix with Justification

Stakeholder	Level of Influence	Level of Interest	Description
Platform Owner	High	High	They define the vision and absorb the financial risk.
Tier-1 Merchants	High	High	High-volume sellers drive the platform's reputation and commission revenue.
Customers	Low	High	Individually low power, but collectively they define the platform's market share.
Payment Gateway	High	Low	They dictate technical security standards; a contract termination would halt all sales
Logistics Partner	Low	Low	Their performance (speed/cost) directly



			dictates customer satisfaction and "churn" rates.
Govt. Regulators	High	Low	They don't care about your UI, but they can shut you down for data or tax non-compliance.

3. Relationship Management Strategies

- **High Power / High Interest (Owners & Tier-1 Merchants):**

Strategy: Strategic Partnership Management. Provide dedicated Account Managers and early access to "Beta" marketing tools to ensure their growth aligns with the platform.

- **High Power / Low Interest (Regulators & Payment Gateways):**

Strategy: Compliance & Risk Mitigation. Conduct bi-annual security audits and legal reviews to ensure 100% uptime and regulatory "peace of mind."

- **Medium Influence / High Interest (Logistics & Consumers):**

Strategy: Operational Transparency. Implement real-time API integrations for tracking and automated dispute resolution to reduce friction in the "buying-to-delivery" cycle.

- **Low Influence / Low Interest (Small-scale Vendors):**

Strategy: Self-Service Support. Provide a robust "Knowledge Base" and automated onboarding to minimize the need for manual intervention.

Conclusion:

Stakeholder mapping for an e-commerce website helps identify all parties involved in the system and understand their influence and expectations. By categorizing stakeholders based on interest and influence, organizations can manage relationships effectively, improve operational efficiency, and deliver a better user experience.